

Running **Valgrind** is a great way to catch memory leaks, invalid memory access, and other sneaky bugs in your C or C++ programs. Here's a quick guide to get you started:

Step-by-Step: Running Valgrind

1. Compile your program with debugging info

- This allows Valgrind to show you line numbers and variable names.

```
gcc -g your_program.c -o your_program
```

2. Run your program with Valgrind

- Use the `--leak-check=full` option for detailed memory leak info.

```
valgrind --leak-check=full ./your_program
```

3. Interpret the output

- Valgrind will show:
 - Invalid reads/writes
 - Use of uninitialized memory
 - Memory leaks (with stack traces)
 - Mismatched malloc/free calls
-

Example

```
#include <stdlib.h>

int main() {
    int *arr = malloc(10 * sizeof(int));
    arr[10] = 42; // Oops! Out-of-bounds write
    return 0;
}
```

Compile and run:

```
gcc -g test.c -o test
valgrind --leak-check=full ./test
```

Valgrind will catch the out-of-bounds write and report it.

Useful Options

Option	Description
<code>--leak-check=full</code>	Detailed info on memory leaks
<code>--track-origins=yes</code>	Shows where uninitialized values come from
<code>--show-leak-kinds=all</code>	Displays all types of leaks

Option	Description
<code>--log-file=valgrind.log</code>	Saves output to a file

Want help interpreting Valgrind output or debugging a specific error? Just drop your code snippet and I'll walk you through it.